

Section C: Writing (40 marks)

Students must answer one question, in Spanish, that relates to a topic, a literary text or a film chosen from the prescribed list featured in section 4.1 (Set topics, literary texts and films). A choice of two questions will be offered for each of the prescribed topics, literary texts and films. Students should write 300-400 words. The assessment rewards students for communicating relevant information effectively as well as for the quality of the Spanish language produced. See assessment criteria in section 4.3.

Students will have individual control over the pace of this examination, including the listening element.

A CD recording will be provided for each student with the examination paper. Centres must ensure that students have access to equipment that permits individual listening (e.g. a CD player with headphones).

4.3 Assessment criteria

General guidance on using levels-based mark schemes

There are three levels-based mark grids to be applied to each individual essay that makes up the written response to works. The mark grids are:

- content and communication (AO2)
- quality of language (Range of lexis) (AO3)
- critical analysis (AO4), organisation and development (AO3).

Deciding on a marking band

- First of all, the examiner will consider the essay as a whole and then decide which descriptors most closely match the answer and place it in that band. The descriptors for each band indicate the different features that will be seen in the student's answer for that band.
- When assigning a band, the examiner will look at the overall quality of the essay and not focus disproportionately on small and specific parts where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different bands of the mark scheme, the examiner will use a 'best fit' approach for defining the band.

Using grids with a range of marks within bands

- Then, the examiner will use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the band that they have selected. For example, if the response is predominantly band 7-9 with a small amount of band 10-12 material, it would be placed in band 7-9 but be awarded a mark near the top of the band because of the band 10-12 content.
- The examiner will modify the mark based on how securely the trait descriptors are met at that band.

Content and communication (AO2)

This mark grid assesses students' ability to understand and respond in writing to written language.

Mark	Content and communication (AO2)
0	No rewardable material.
1–3	• The student has shown minimal factual knowledge of the topic, literary text or film. • There is no relevant supporting evidence from the topic, literary text or film. • Only superficial details in the response.
4–6	• The student has shown some basic, generic factual knowledge of the topic, literary text or film. • There is limited relevant supporting evidence from the topic, literary text or film. • There is limited depth in the response.
7–9	• The student has shown acceptable factual knowledge of the topic, literary text or film. • There is some variety of relevant supporting evidence from the topic, literary text or film. • There is some depth in the response.
10–12	• The student has shown good factual knowledge of the topic, literary text or film. • There is a good range of relevant supporting evidence from the topic, literary text or film. • There is a good level of depth in the response.
13–15	• The student has shown excellent factual knowledge of the topic, literary text or film. • There is a wide range of relevant supporting evidence from the topic, literary text or film. • There is a high level of depth in the response.

Quality of language (Range of lexis)(A03)

The following mark grid assesses students' ability to use a range of lexis and structures.

Mark	Quality of language (A03)
0	No rewardable language.
1	• Communication is only occasionally achieved even at a basic level. • Grammatical structures are basic and mostly used incorrectly. • Vocabulary is often lacking or incorrect.
2	• Communication is sometimes achieved at a basic level. • Student has used mostly common structures, and these are sometimes used correctly. • Vocabulary is limited in range.
3	• Communication is achieved most of the time. • Common grammatical structures are mostly used correctly, and though there is some use of less common structures, they may contain errors. • Vocabulary is acceptable in range.
4	• Communication is achieved almost all of the time. • A good range of common grammatical structures are used correctly; some less common structures are used correctly. • Vocabulary is good in range and includes specialist terms relevant to the topic, literary text or film.
5	• Communication is fluent and varied throughout. • A wide range of both common and less common grammatical structures are mostly used correctly. • Vocabulary is excellent in range and shows knowledge of many specialist terms relevant to the topic, literary text or film.

Critical analysis (AO4), Organisation and development (AO3)

This mark grid assesses students' ability to critically analyse key issues, as well as give an individual response, forming arguments and linking ideas.

Mark	Critical analysis (AO4), Organisation and development (AO3)
0	No evidence of a critical, analytical understanding of the topic, literary text or film.
1–4	• (AO4) A superficial description in response to the question that shows minimal engagement with the topic, literary text or film, sufficient only to make a basic response. • (AO3) Limited links between ideas, leading to limited coherence throughout. • (AO4) Lacks conclusive remarks that are linked to, or substantiated by, the essay content.
5–8	• (AO4) A partial explanation in response to the question that shows partial engagement with the topic, literary text or film. • (AO3) Occasional links between ideas and some attempts to justify these, and organisation within paragraphs or sections is sometimes present. • (AO4) Conclusive remarks that may only be tangentially linked to, and are only occasionally substantiated by, the essay content.
9–12	• (AO4) A full explanation in response to the question that shows moderate engagement with the topic, literary text or film. • (AO3) Some justified links between ideas, and coherent organisation between paragraphs is occasionally present. • (AO4) Conclusive remarks which are linked to the essay and are sometimes substantiated by the essay content.
13–16	• (AO4) A critical analysis in response to the question, albeit applied inconsistently, that shows substantial engagement with the topic, literary text or film. • (AO3) Justified links between ideas, and coherent organisation between paragraphs is mostly present. • (AO4) Conclusive remarks which are linked to the essay, are mostly substantiated by the essay content and show a developing individual response.
17–20	• (AO4) A full evaluation in response to the question that shows excellent engagement with the topic, literary text or film. • (AO3) Consistently justified links between ideas leading to a well-organised and coherently developed argument throughout. • (AO4) Conclusive remarks which are linked to the essay, are always substantiated by the essay content and show insightful observations that form an individual response.